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# Agent Ecosystem Working Group 3: Trust and Certification

Sep 17, 2026

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Working group initiative established certification criteria for artificial intelligence agents via collaborative assessment reviews.

**Initiative objectives and scope**

- The working group will evaluate agentic capabilities to establish certification criteria and trust standards.
- Results from the agent ready award assessment will be released at MacX in Amsterdam.
- Everett Zufelt explained that the working group will recommend certification updates to the board.

**Agentic solutions and certification scope**

- The initiative addresses whether to certify recurring agentic solutions alongside existing member companies.
- Cecily Shives noted that 35 to 40 members out of 125 achieved agent ready recognition.
- The team discussed establishing validation or verification standards for probabilistic agentic claims.

**Backlog review and meeting schedule**

- Everett Zufelt presented backlog items addressing certification criteria gaps and shared vocabulary terms.
- The team discussed evaluating evidence standards for probabilistic claims and agent platform runtimes.
- The next meeting is scheduled for October 1, with flexibility to adjust for travel schedules.

**Next steps**

- [ ] [Cecily Shives] Share Certification Criteria: Provide the existing certification criteria documents to the working group.
- [ ] [Rebecca Lyus] Resolve Slack Access: Help Ronak restore his access to the community Slack platform.
- [ ] [Rebecca Lyus] Create Task Poll: Publish a poll in the Slack channel to determine which project issues the team should address first.
- [ ] [Gus Fune] Gather Documentation: Retrieve and share previous certification criteria and relevant notes from past working groups.

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# 📝 Full notes

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# Agent Ecosystem Working Group 3: Trust and Certification

Invited Connect (Crossbeam) gus@div-brands.com mark.dorsi@netlify.com ronan.conlon@mongodb.com Rebecca Lyus Cecily Shives ronakbsh@amazon.com deepak_madhavan@gap.com

Attachments Agent Ecosystem Working Group 3: Trust and Certification

Meeting records Transcript

## Summary

Working group initiative established certification criteria for artificial intelligence agents via collaborative assessment reviews.

**Working Group Initiative Objectives**
Initiative established certification criteria for prevalent artificial intelligence agents. Assessments will contribute to annual awards released at MacX in Amsterdam.

**Review of Certification Rubrics**
Review of current rubrics determined gaps exist as members introduce agentic capabilities. Technical review process involves 2 unbiased reviewers to prevent conflicts of interest.

**Assessment of Agentic Solutions**
Group discussed whether agentic solutions require separate validation or seals of approval. Standards will apply consistently across achievement awards and checklists.

## Next steps

- ☐ [Cecily Shives] Share Certification Criteria: Provide the existing certification criteria documents to the working group.
- ☐ [Rebecca Lyus] Resolve Slack Access: Help Ronak restore his access to the community Slack platform.
- ☐ [Rebecca Lyus] Create Task Poll: Publish a poll in the Slack channel to determine which project issues the team should address first.
- ☐ [Gus Fune] Gather Documentation: Retrieve and share previous certification criteria and relevant notes from past working groups.

## Details

- **Working Group Initiative and Objectives**: Rebecca Lyus introduced the working group's core mission to examine agentic capabilities affecting certification and trust, aiming to establish certification criteria for prevalent artificial intelligence agents (00:04:20). The developed assessments will contribute to the annual agent ready award, with results set to be released at MacX in Amsterdam (00:03:06).
- **Impact on Membership Admission and Certification**: Ronak Shah asked whether the initiative applies to independent software vendors and system integrators, to which Everett Zufelt confirmed it applies to both, alongside platform vendors. Cecily Shives raised questions regarding how these changes would affect new member admissions and the agent ecosystem program, prompting Everett to explain that recommendations would be made to the board regarding potential updates to certification criteria and helping existing members adapt to rapid market changes (00:05:45).
- **Participant Professional Roles and Affiliations**: Rebecca Lyus outlined their role as data and systems manager at the Mac Alliance, while Cecily Shives described their position as partnerships director at ML Alliance (00:08:06).

Everett Zufelt detailed wearing two hats as vice president of agentic systems at Orium and program lead for the agent ecosystem at the Mac Alliance (00:09:07). Ronak Shah shared their role as a principal architect at Amazon Web Services working with independent software vendors and system integrators in retail and consumer packaged goods. Ronan Conlon introduced themself as an industry consultant for retail in Europe, the Middle East, and Africa at MongoDB and former vice president of engineering at Rent the Runway (00:10:08). Gus Fune described their role as chief technology officer at Bearskin and a Mac ambassador who previously worked on architect certification (00:11:53).

- **Origins and Background of the Initiative**: Everett Zufelt explained that the working group was formed in response to rapid technological shifts and end-user questions from chief information officers, chief technology officers, and digital teams regarding the validity of agentic solutions (00:15:07) (00:18:24). Everett highlighted three main intersection points: updating alliance certification, ensuring awards are backed by credible criteria, and deciding whether to certify repeatable solutions (such as commerce and content accelerators) rather than just certifying companies (00:17:15). Cecily Shives clarified that while the alliance currently grants an agent ready recognition for discoverability based on live projects—achieved by 35 to 40 out of 125 members—it is a discoverability award rather than a formal certification credential (00:20:49).
- **Review of Certification Rubrics and Criteria Gaps**: Everett Zufelt introduced the first GitHub backlog item, which involves reviewing current certification rubrics to determine if gaps exist as members introduce agentic capabilities and solutions (00:23:05). Ronan Conlon asked where to find the existing Mac certification criteria, and Cecily Shives offered to share the documentation from Google Drive (00:24:32). Everett outlined the technical review process, which traditionally involves two unbiased reviewers from opposing categories—solution providers reviewing tech vendors and vice versa—to prevent conflicts of interest (00:25:24). Gus Fune inquired about the openness to changing the criteria, and both Everett and Cecily confirmed that the alliance is fully open to making necessary adjustments to better serve members and end-users (00:26:21).
- **Shared Vocabulary and Probabilistic Evidence Standards**: Everett Zufelt proposed establishing a shared vocabulary to prevent prolonged debates over definitions during meetings, noting that the enterprise agent architecture

working group had already completed preliminary work that could be utilized (00:27:19). Everett also raised the question of establishing an evidence standard for probabilistic claims, noting that evaluating probabilistic agent results is significantly more complex than evaluating deterministic systems (00:28:30).

- **Assessment of Agentic Solutions, Platforms, and Runtimes**: Everett Zufelt discussed the need to form an opinion on whether agentic solutions require a separate certification, validation, or seal of approval, and how such solutions should be assessed (00:29:56). Everett and Ronak Shah discussed the role of agent platforms and runtimes, with Ronak raising the consideration of whether runtimes should provide sandboxes for executing untrusted code written by agents (00:32:45). Everett noted that in a composable world, while code execution should occur in a sandbox, it remains an open question whether the sandbox must be part of the platform or composed into the solution (00:34:29).
- **Application Across Programs and Next Steps**: Everett Zufelt reviewed the final backlog item concerning how to apply standards consistently across various offerings, including agentic achievement awards, the agentic readiness checklist, certification, and the upcoming agent solutions hub (00:34:29). Ronak Shah raised an issue regarding the loss of Slack access due to Amazon work restrictions, and Rebecca Lyus agreed to assist in resolving the access (00:37:03). Rebecca noted that the next recurring meeting is planned for October 1st, with flexibility to move it to Friday if needed due to travel, and announced plans to post a poll in Slack to determine which backlog issue the group should tackle first (00:38:24).

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# 📖 Transcript

Sep 17, 2026

# Agent Ecosystem Working Group 3: Trust and Certification - Transcript

## 00:00:22

**Cecily Shives:** Kevin.

**Gus Fune:** I don't think we before

**Everett Zufelt:** Good morning.

**Cecily Shives:** We maybe met we would have met briefly at one of the um one of the mock conferences.

**Gus Fune:** maybe.

**Cecily Shives:** Yeah, maybe.

**Gus Fune:** Yes.

**Cecily Shives:** I run um I run our partnerships at Mock Alliance, so I I manage all of our memberships and um and the admissions piece as well. Yeah. Yeah. I'm uh I'm looking forward to this group kicking off.

**Gus Fune:** Rebecca, how you doing?

**Rebecca Lyus:** I'm doing good, thank you. And yourself?

**Gus Fune:** Nah,

**Rebecca Lyus:** No.

**Cecily Shives:** No,

**Gus Fune:** I got COVID, so I'm stuck.

**Everett Zufelt:** Oh.

**Cecily Shives:** you did.

**Rebecca Lyus:** Oh.

**Gus Fune:** Yeah, so it's like a blast from the past. Vintage sickness.

**Cecily Shives:** I know.

**Rebecca Lyus:** Oh, it's a little bit, isn't it?

**Cecily Shives:** Well,

**Rebecca Lyus:** Oh,

**Cecily Shives:** I hope you kick it quick.

**Rebecca Lyus:** yeah.

**Ronan Conlon:** Hello.

**Cecily Shives:** How you doing,

**Gus Fune:** I'm running.

**Rebecca Lyus:** Hello.

**Ronan Conlon:** Right.

**Cecily Shives:** Rebecca?

## 00:01:56

**Rebecca Lyus:** So,

**Cecily Shives:** How many folks are you expecting?

**Rebecca Lyus:** uh just a Ronak now. Uh the Gus has not RSVPd unfortunately. Uh I am however just going to put the GitHub repository into the chat just so people can have a quick look while we just wait for a few more people to join.

**Cecily Shives:** Rebecca,

**Rebecca Lyus:** Uh

**Cecily Shives:** you might just ping Gus and just see if he can make it. Like, you know, some people just don't accept stuff. Just might ping him and see if he can make it.

**Rebecca Lyus:** yeah, it's all good. I'm doing so now.

**Gus Fune:** Yeah. Last week when we spoke, he was in three meetings at once, which was Put you in three.

**Rebecca Lyus:** Yeah.

**Cecily Shives:** That's crazy.

**Ronan Conlon:** Um, I actually have a hard stop in like 30 minutes or so. So, just in case I uh dramatically disappear.

**Cecily Shives:** That's okay.

**Rebecca Lyus:** So good.

**Cecily Shives:** We know you have your show and tell.

**Everett Zufelt:** Yes,

**Ronan Conlon:** Ah, yeah.

**Everett Zufelt:** I also I also I also have to drop as I think I am hosting TED show and tell.

## 00:03:06

**Cecily Shives:** Yeah. Oh, yes. I think you both are out there.

**Everett Zufelt:** Yes.

**Rebecca Lyus:** So we'll do a fairly short first session and because this is mainly to

**Everett Zufelt:** Yeah.

**Rebecca Lyus:** just have a look see what we're wanting to establish over the next couple of months and then we can do the activity based stuff in the next session although the next session will be just after MacX. Uh is anyone here going to be joining us for MacX in Amsterdam? Excited to see people.

**Gus Fune:** I'll be there. But I can't make on the meeting afterwards because I have not come back.

**Rebecca Lyus:** Hope.

**Gus Fune:** I'm extended one extra day in the Netherlands.

**Rebecca Lyus:** Oh,

**Cecily Shives:** Good for you.

**Rebecca Lyus:** I'm trying to convince the team to uh do a stroop and waffle uh stroop and waffle cooking class. Apparently, it's a class of one. Uh need to convince people. All right. So, I'm just getting my notes from our call bus. Right. I've sent DM message.

## 00:04:20

**Rebecca Lyus:** We'll see if he joins. Let's go over the agenda for today. So, how have people had a chance to read through the GitHub before now?

**Ronan Conlon:** Not in depth.

**Rebecca Lyus:** That is that. Um so just to give a quick overview of the initiative, this working group is going to be looking at the agentic capabilities that are affecting certification and trust. It is to determine the certification criteria and what needs to be added to assess agentic capabilities because we understand that agentic capabilities are slightly different. Agents are now becoming very prevalent. How do we know what's right? What how do we trust something? So we're wanting to help people giving them a certain criteria giving certifications and that's um it's the start of things. We are have also mentioned about using the assessment that we create for the annual agent ready award which we will be releasing the results to at MacX. So we have quite some time to go and cultivate something. But yeah, so over to you Ronak.

## 00:05:45

**Ronak Shah:** It's Ron from AWS. Good to meet you everyone. Uh, is this for both ISVS and SIS or are

**Everett Zufelt:** Yes.

**Ronak Shah:** we

**Everett Zufelt:** Uh uh well so ISVS, platform vendors and SIS. Yep. Now I think it's going to apply differently uh in all those scenarios. Um but yeah, we're going to cover all of them.

**Cecily Shives:** I have a question and I'm asked to just kind of be a fly on the wall because I manage our mock alliance admissions now and I've been man I'm I'm handing agent ready over to Rebecca but like h I guess h I would like to understand and we don't have to figure it out today but like how this might impact at bringing new members into the alliance or into our Agent ecosystem program. Um, and and are there like pathways to to work closer together on that or even with Mike who works with me on admissions and recruiting new members to apply for membership via certification or come in as a collaborator which is our free program specific to agent ecosystem.

## 00:06:59

**Everett Zufelt:** So I think There's two ways that it's going to impact that. I I think one is it is probable though not

**Ronak Shah:** I forgot.

**Everett Zufelt:** definitive that criteria around certification will change. It's not going to change tomorrow.

**Cecily Shives:** I hope not.

**Everett Zufelt:** Uh and I think this group's right and this group's role will be to make a recommendation to the board. Right. we we won't we as a group can't change things but we might take a look uh and then recommend to the board hey here's how we think certification should change.

**Ronak Shah:** What's

**Everett Zufelt:** So I think that's that's the one way um for new members and then probably and again probably will change over an even longer period of time

**Gus Fune:** It's pretty

**Everett Zufelt:** is for existing members how do we make sure that we are all adapting to the needs of the market uh as all these things are changing so rapidly around us. So, I think both of those things are going to change, but obviously um you know takes change takes time and and we'll make recommendations to the board around both those.

## 00:08:06

**Cecily Shives:** It's

**Everett Zufelt:** Downs.

**Rebecca Lyus:** I have also realized I very much dived into this without small talking, without doing introductions and some people might not know each other. So I do apologize for that. I get very excited and just want to go. Um so just before we go any further, did we want to do introductions or do we all know each other?

**Ronan Conlon:** It certainly helped me.

**Cecily Shives:** Yeah.

**Rebecca Lyus:** No problem. I'm really sorry about that.

**Gus Fune:** I I was just talking on LinkedIn because

**Rebecca Lyus:** I get over excited. Yeah. Um, so I'm Rebecca Lyus. I'm the data and systems manager of the Mac Alliance. I am internal. I am here to facilitate your needs, to help you with what you need to produce things, to get conversations started, and just be extra keen.

**Everett Zufelt:** I also a true flawful connoisseur.

**Rebecca Lyus:** any snack connoisseur.

**Everett Zufelt:** Yeah.

**Rebecca Lyus:** I'm just here for the snacks. All right, I'm going to pass it over to Cecily.

## 00:09:07

**Ronak Shah:** Jesus.

**Cecily Shives:** Yep. Uh, I'm Cecily. I'm I'm partnerships director at ML Alliance. So, um, like I said, I work with all of our members. I am also probably Holly's troublemaker. I have

my hands in in in various things, but my remmit is supposed to be all all things membership admission throughout their entire um journey from admissions all the way down to like getting the most out of out of membership. So, um h I will most likely be a fly on the wall, but as there are changes to our admissions and criteria and things like that, I I'll I'll remain involved with you guys.

**Everett Zufelt:** I can go next. Uh Everett Zufelt, I wear two hats. Uh I am the VP of aentic systems at Orium. We're a system integrator uh based out of Toronto. We work mostly in the Americas. Uh and then my second hat is uh for the last six or seven months or so I've been supporting the mock alliance as the program lead for the agent ecosystem.

## 00:10:08

**Everett Zufelt:** So just coordinating the different work groups and thought leadership to ensure that we're we're moving the the program forward uh with a little bit of thought to our coordination. Maybe Ron, do you want to go

**Ronak Shah:** Yep. Ch uh at AWS and been involved with um my clients from very early days. uh I uh in AWS I work uh with uh ISVS and SIS uh in retail and CPG uh side um as an principal uh architect and uh yeah looking forward to this uh there are few different initiative like uh uh AI uh geni competencies is uh uh and there are some aspects maybe you know come up as an similar uh what AWS is doing from uh AI competencies. So happy to kind of bring those learning over here and work with this group.

**Ronan Conlon:** I'll go.

**Rebecca Lyus:** Thank you.

**Ronan Conlon:** Um, hi everybody. I'm Ronan Conlon. I work for MongoDB. Um my role at MongoDB is uh an industry consultant for retail in AMIA specifically. So I spent most of my MongoD DB career thinking about Agentic Commerce and applications uh of of Agentic Commerce and how it's evolving in the in the retail industry.

## 00:11:53

**Ronan Conlon:** Uh my background is kind of in software. for delivery. Before MongoDB, I was a VP of engineering at Rent the Runway. Um, you might have heard of him in the Stateside, uh, a women's fashion rental company. Um, so I spent five or six years there. Uh, and before that did a lot of B2B e-commerce and bunch of stuff like that with, uh, companies you've never heard of, uh, because they're obscure and in the background. Um, but yeah, uh, nice to be here. Um, yeah, looking forward to contributing.

**Gus Fune:** I'm Gus. Um, I'm CTO at Bearskine, which is a clothing company. Don't look online, otherwise you'll be bombarded with ads forever. Uh, jokes aside, I'm also a market ambassador. So, I'm bringing more of the perspective of buyer side, what who's on the other side of the desk looking for. So that's what probably me and Gus were in here. We're both MAC ambassadors. I've worked in many initiatives as well. Um probably most known one was last year.

## 00:12:56

**Gus Fune:** I've been like judging awards and this kind of stuff, but I also helped with the architect certification last year and that's why I ended up here because I like certifying things.

**Cecily Shives:** You're in the right spot.

**Ronak Shah:** I'm based in New York area. Uh, where are you based guys?

**Gus Fune:** I'm in I'm in a we town called Firmland, but for most people just for general geography, it's near Edinburgh in Scotland.

**Ronak Shah:** Okay.

**Ronan Conlon:** I was wondering whether

**Everett Zufelt:** And then I'll I I I live in the middle of nowhere. For Americans, I say I live four hours north of Fargo, North Dakota. And for Canadians, I say I live just outside of

Winnipeg. And if you don't know where either one of those things is, I live pretty much exactly east west in the smack dab center of Canada.

**Ronak Shah:** It gets very cold.

**Everett Zufelt:** It get we get we we get a few minus 40 days in February.

**Gus Fune:** Is it in Manitoba?

**Everett Zufelt:** Yes, exactly.

**Gus Fune:** Oh,

**Everett Zufelt:** Yeah.

**Gus Fune:** that's the that's the place that has no rats.

## 00:14:03

**Gus Fune:** I I would like to know more about that later. Or is it Alberta?

**Everett Zufelt:** Well, we have no there's a lot of things we don't have because it gets too cold, but yes.

**Rebecca Lyus:** What?

**Ronan Conlon:** I'm I'm in Gway by the way on the west coast of Ireland. So

**Cecily Shives:** Oh, I love Ireland. I'm in Austin, Texas. I don't have as nearly as beautiful architecture as the rest of you here.

**Ronan Conlon:** stay weird. Isn't that what you guys say?

**Cecily Shives:** There. Yeah. Stay weird. Keep Austin weird.

**Rebecca Lyus:** Huh?

**Ronan Conlon:** Yeah.

**Rebecca Lyus:** I'm over in England, uh, about 3 hours north of London. It's hard to pinpoint.

**Gus Fune:** I mean three hours sometimes it takes from one side to London from the other one. So the technical It can be London.

**Rebecca Lyus:** Yeah, this is true.

**Gus Fune:** I joke I joke that I live on zone 10 of the London tube because sometimes I can get quicker to London and actually move across London.

## 00:15:07

**Rebecca Lyus:** It is. It is. All right. So, where would people like to start?

**Everett Zufelt:** Does does it work if I give like a just a couple minutes background of where this came from?

**Rebecca Lyus:** Yeah.

**Cecily Shives:** Yes.

**Everett Zufelt:** And there's one thing and then we do have uh G I'm not sure Gus if you had a chance to see but uh uh Gus and I did a line around uh we'll call it a candidate recommendations in a backlog and those are all up on GitHub. Um does that help if we go through those two things and then and then from there we can just probably align on kind of next step and and how we want to uh move this forward. Cool.

**Rebecca Lyus:** That feels logical.

**Everett Zufelt:** So, where did this all come from? Everything's moving too fast. And I I struggle saying those words out loud because there are very few people who want to move faster than me.

**Ronak Shah:** Sweet.

**Everett Zufelt:** I am highly biased toward action. Uh but the world is moving very fast and it's having implications on um everything really.

## 00:16:10

**Ronan Conlon:** Come over.

**Everett Zufelt:** And there's a few different angles that kind of are colliding at once within the mock world. Uh one is uh you know our end users who are like hey like at like

at the end of the day we are here to serve end users like we're here to serve the CIOS, the CTOs, the the digital teams, the people who are trying to build and grow commercial businesses and and they're coming with lots of questions. Should should I invest in this technology? Is this going to support me with my needs around AI and agents in the future? Um, you know, hey, I heard I saw somebody talk about this cool agentic solution. Is it real? Is it not real? Uh, these are the questions that we hear quite often right now. Uh, and so as a as an organization, there's a few different intersection points we're seeing. One is around certification. So, like just as members who've always been here or new members like Cesley had uh raised, is there something we need to think about changing around that?

## 00:17:15

**Everett Zufelt:** Because when all of us, well, most of us got certified into the mock alliance originally, agents were more of a hypothesis than a real thing. Certainly, as agents present themselves in technology today. So, that's one angle. Second one is we like giving out awards to our members because it makes people feel good and you know yay yay. Uh I like getting awards. Uh so you know how do we make sure that when we're giving out awards when we're lending the mock alliance name and reputation to a member or an enduser an organization or like how do we make sure we're doing that based on something. credible and real. Uh and third one is uh and this is a this is something we've never done before.

**Ronak Shah:** I There it is.

**Everett Zufelt:** I won't say it's a new problem. I think it's an expanding problem. Like there's we today certify uh technology vendors. We also certify solution providers or system integrators. Um there's this thing that sits between them which is the solution itself which we've never really certified.

## 00:18:24

**Everett Zufelt:** uh uh you know and so whether it's an accelerator for commerce or content or or now

**Gus Fune:** I know.

**Everett Zufelt:** as especially as we look through like say the mock AI exchange where where teams are getting together to build solutions for different brands I is there a need for us to look at what does it take to certify not just the SI and not just the ISV but that repeatable solution that's being put into the market and though. And so all of these questions about who should I trust and what should I trust and how do we give out an award and what does

**Ronak Shah:** What's

**Everett Zufelt:** certification mean and should we start certifying agentic solutions alongside members. There was enough of these questions that we decided to pull some smart people together uh the group of all of you uh to try to figure out what the answers are.

**Ronak Shah:** up?

**Everett Zufelt:** So that's the background. I'll pause there. thoughts or questions or reactions about all of that?

**Ronak Shah:** So instead of the companies we want to endorse or certify the the solution itself.

## 00:19:41

**Ronak Shah:** else.

**Everett Zufelt:** I I don't think instead of I think we're always going to want to certify the company. The question mark is might we also want to certify the solution? So if uh if a if somebody comes along and says hey I see this agentic solution out there should I trust it you know do we want to have uh and maybe maybe it's a word lower than certification maybe it's validation or verification do we

**Cecily Shives:** Mhm.

**Everett Zufelt:** want to have a stance on the solution along with the certification we do for companies and I don't think we have an answer right we don't that it's a it's it's

certainly an open question it's not an answered one. I think part of this group's job is to come up with a recommendation for the board around that both the value side of it. Is it valuable to end users to have that sort of validation verification of solutions? Is it practical? Like I mean it's wonderful if we want to do it. Is it even a practical thing to be able to do?

## 00:20:49

**Everett Zufelt:** So, I think there's a there's a lot of things we'd have to talk about and think through to come up with a recommendation.

**Cecily Shives:** And just so you all are aware now like when we're certifying members although now I do have a question on on all of the admissions uh almost all of the admissions templates on like what what is your agentic strategy but we're not certifying anything agentic at the moment. We're just trying to gain awareness and information. I'm happy to feed that back to this this group.

**Ronak Shah:** That's great.

**Cecily Shives:** What we are doing to bring members up to speed is we're not certifying them. We're giving them an agent ready recognition or award for um discoverability purposes within our directory. So if an end user is like I have a search whatever and I need it to be agent ready like mock Alliance has done that first level of like trust and due diligence and there's only there's like 35 maybe 40 of our members out of the 125 that I have now that have achieved that agent ready and we'll try to bring more folks into it but it's not a um certification

## 00:21:59

**Ronak Shah:** Try to

**Cecily Shives:** credential it's it's it's a discoverability kind of award.

**Everett Zufelt:** It's more do you have proof you've done some stuff?

**Cecily Shives:** Yeah. And they have to have live project,

**Everett Zufelt:** Yeah.

**Cecily Shives:** not necessarily public,

**Everett Zufelt:** Yes.

**Cecily Shives:** but live projects.

**Everett Zufelt:** Yes. Does does that answer the question though around certification? Definitely going to keep certifying companies. Question is do we want to do some sort of you know seal of approval on Agentic Solutions as well. Any other questions before I go into just the backlog list? Sure.

**Gus Fune:** I think I have a bunch of stuff to put in the backlog, but I'll leave those questions slash concerns later.

**Everett Zufelt:** Okay. Why don't we jump into the backlog and and uh Rebecca, I shared the link to it uh in the Slack channel. It's just the issues backlog in the GitHub repo.

**Rebecca Lyus:** Yeah.

**Everett Zufelt:** Oh. Oh. Uh housekeeping.

**Ronak Shah:** That's

**Everett Zufelt:** I think everybody has access or has been invited to this GitHub repo.

# 00:23:05

**Everett Zufelt:** So, drop me a note if you haven't and we'll add you. And then secondly, I think you've all been invited to the Slack channel,

**Rebecca Lyus:** Heat.

**Everett Zufelt:** but let Rebecca know if you haven't and and she'll make sure you get in there as well. So, I'm going to read this list uh from the bottom up because I put them in in order and had I been thinking, I would have put them in in reverse order. Um so, the f the first item at the very bottom of the list is just go back and take a look like like some of you have been

**Gus Fune:** Take it.

**Everett Zufelt:** involved. Uh Ron, I know for sure we've been on the calls together in some of those tech evals as part of the as part of the member certification process. And so one of the issues in here is just go take a look at the certification process, put it in the light of um you know what are the criteria we certify against consider it in the light of systems that now may include agentic capabilities so you know uh or or or sis who may be delivering agentic solutions and are there additional questions are there different criteria you know we may look at it all and say actually you know like you know agents are just another way of using technology techology and all of the stuff we have around architecture, safety, credibility, it all you know we don't need to add anything.

## 00:24:32

**Everett Zufelt:** We may look at it and decide we do need to add something. So the first question is go look at the current certification uh rubrics and and ask are there gaps that we think need to be addressed as as our members are starting to bring more agent capabilities and solutions into their into their organizations and bringing them to their customers. So, let me I'll pause there. Any thoughts or questions about that one before I proceed? That one should be pretty straightforward. I don't know what the answers will be, but I think that one's pretty straightforward.

**Gus Fune:** I have some.

**Ronan Conlon:** Uh just I was just going to ask a silly question which is

**Gus Fune:** No, go on. Go on. Go around.

**Ronan Conlon:** like where is the existing MAC certification criteria?

**Everett Zufelt:** Oh, that's a great question. I And short answer somewhere on Google Drive, but we'll we'll Yeah,

**Cecily Shives:** I can share it with you.

**Everett Zufelt:** we'll get access to it. Yes.

**Ronan Conlon:** Cool. Um and for context,

# 00:25:24

**Everett Zufelt:** Yeah,

**Ronan Conlon:** this is literally my first Mac meeting ever. Uh so Uh yeah, but much appreciated.

**Everett Zufelt:** it's it's it's a it's a good question and and it's like there's a bunch of documentation and that I don't I haven't done this for a while, but then there's like normally the process has in the past been and I assume it's probably similar now. um on the technical review we tend to have two reviewers so that it's

**Cecily Shives:** Mhm.

**Everett Zufelt:** unbias or mostly unbiased and then we also um have tended to have you know if we're reviewing an SI we don't have other SI reviewers if we're reviewing

**Cecily Shives:** H

**Rebecca Lyus:** Yeah.

**Everett Zufelt:** a tech vendor we don't have other tech vendors reviewers so we have solution providers review uh tech vendors tech vendors review solution providers again just to remove any perception of conflict of

**Cecily Shives:** I've just reorganized all of this stuff so I can get it to and and and share with the broader

**Everett Zufelt:** Then we can dig in. Yeah,

**Rebecca Lyus:** perfect.

**Everett Zufelt:** perfect.

# 00:26:21

**Everett Zufelt:** Was there another question on that one?

**Gus Fune:** I think I was going to ask the same thing if we could see the criteria and I know it's not only the document.

**Everett Zufelt:** Absolutely.

**Gus Fune:** I know there is like a check a checklist and there's a support card and those things that that goes in there and my second question would be if how open is it for suggesting for changing that because I know a thing or two about the certification criteria that depending on how we take the direction here in the sense of like things I have as a pain points myself when buying things Uh-huh. um that will probably require some amending in there or might require be an extra step in our side.

**Everett Zufelt:** Yep.

**Gus Fune:** Uh I don't know if you're going to keep those things together separate or as an appendex to the general process. I'm actually getting ahead and adding a bunch of questions on top of this one.

**Everett Zufelt:** I I would say we are I mean we wouldn't have this working group together. Something big is changing has changed and is changing in the world.

## 00:27:19

**Everett Zufelt:** We would not be pulling this group of people together if we were not open to making changes like

**Cecily Shives:** I'm very open to making changes.

**Everett Zufelt:** it at the end. Yeah. At the end of the day certification serves uh you know serves our members, right? It serves our members, it serves our end users, and if it's not serving well, we need to we need to change it so that it does. So, I think we're quite open. Okay, the next one as I move up, agree a shared vocabulary. So, um why? because I find that uh if we don't agree on what words mean, we spend most of our meetings debating it. So, if we could just agree on certain things, I don't even know what exactly all the things are we need to agree on. I also know the the the enterprise agent architecture working group has already done a little bit of work here. we could probably steal. Um,

**Rebecca Lyus:** We

**Everett Zufelt:** but if we can't lock down what words mean, we end up spending a lot of time arguing about words rather than arguing about policy during every one of our conversations.

## 00:28:30

**Everett Zufelt:** So, there's probably like a hey, is there a handful of terms that if we could just agree to disagree about what they mean one time, we could save ourselves probably a lot of pain over over the next few months. Um the next one um and so we'll keep moving up. Uh is there an evidence standard we want to set? And again the answer might be no but for probabilistic claims right so like you know when when a vendor is selling to you hey look it can do x y and z it's like okay well it's really easy well easier to prove something in a deterministic system it it is harder to prove how agents work uh or the results they may or may not Is there something we want to do there? Whether it's anecdotal evidence, whether it's, you know, qualitative case study evidence, uh whether it's like, hey, here's here's a we ran this we ran these five scenarios 20 times each and here's what like I'm not sure what we want to do, but things are a little bit harder to evaluate in probabilistic versus deterministic systems where the right answer is out.

## 00:29:56

**Everett Zufelt:** not always determinable and also changes from run to run. So there's an open question there. Any thoughts or questions about that one?

**Ronak Shah:** That makes sense.

**Everett Zufelt:** Okay. Uh the next one, and we touched on this earlier a couple of times, um write down an opinion piece on whether or not, and maybe it's something we publish even publicly, but I think we need to form that opinion on whether or not agentic solutions requires certification or assessment. I mean, maybe it's not the Cword, but maybe assessment and some sort of seal of approval uh outside of members directly. So again, it's an open question. I think we need to have some people stick their heads together, debate it, struggle through it together, uh, and come up with a point of view that we can share. There's I think there's pros and cons both directions. I can see where it could be valuable to buyers. I can see where it could be

impractical to actually do the assessment. And so I think we're going to have to sort through it a bit.

## 00:31:20

**Everett Zufelt:** uh if we do think we need to assess a dentic solutions, how are we going to do it? And so that's what that next item is in the list. What is the instrument we use? Is it you know, you know, how how how do we do the assessment of that solution? How do we gather the data? Can we build an agent that assesses agents? you know, maybe in part uh you know, how do we actually assess Agentic Solutions if we decide that that's a valuable thing to do? Um the next one on the list I'll say is, you know, and again this is where maybe we get into the definition of terms like if we have an agentic solution, that's one thing. You know, we have SI, ISVS, we know what those things are. um agent platforms or maybe we'll you know again we can define terms later agent runtimes agent platforms so where is that agentic solution what upon what is the agentic solution being built and where is it running is there value in us being able to have a conversation around uh assessing those platforms separately from uh the assessment of the solution or the member uh or the SI or the ISV.

## 00:32:45

**Everett Zufelt:** Does that one make sense? Like there's we have agents, but those agents run on and and on top of something and and so how do we assess the thing upon or should And how do we assess the thing on which they run? Any questions on that one?

**Ronak Shah:** No.

**Rebecca Lyus:** All sounding good and making sense so far.

**Ronak Shah:** Yeah. like uh when you're framing this are you kind of thinking like hey as an solution provider if an agent going to generate something like untrusted code then

are you uh you know using um a sandbox to run that uh are are you thinking along that line or

**Everett Zufelt:** I I'm I certainly have that in my head a lot. And so I think that's both you know what you described there is both a a question for if we were to assess the solution right if we assess an agentic solution

**Ronak Shah:** something.

**Everett Zufelt:** and it's writing all sorts of Python as and and and executing it somewhere as part of the solution is it doing that safely right I think that's a good question and then also as we as we think about uh agent platforms and runtimes If we decide we we want to hold a point of view on those um do they make it pop like you know does the runtime make it provide a sandbox for code execution or not right I think and I think hey in a in a world of

## 00:34:29

**Ronak Shah:** Mhm.

**Everett Zufelt:** composability um I don't I don't think a runtime or an agent platform has to provide a sandbox for code execution. I think if you're going to if an agent's going to write code and it gets executed, it should be in a sandbox. Um whether that sandbox is part of the platform or some other sandbox you compose into the solution, I think is is a question mark. But yeah, I certainly think those are the types of questions I think we need to work through.

**Ronak Shah:** Okay. Sounds good.

**Everett Zufelt:** Yeah.

**Ronak Shah:** I do have to jump in five minutes also.

**Everett Zufelt:** Yeah.

**Ronak Shah:** Uh

**Everett Zufelt:** La the last one on the list then is where do we apply these things? So again, I think we've mentioned there's Agentic achievement awards, there's the Aentic readiness checklist, there's certification, there's um you know for anybody there's I think soon we're launching something called the uh agent solutions hub which

showcases aic solutions across the e like so as we're how do we make sure that we're applying while maybe we don't need to apply apply the exact same standard in all of those different places.

## 00:35:57

**Everett Zufelt:** How do we make sure we're consistently leveraging a a shared

**Ronak Shah:** That's good.

**Everett Zufelt:** understanding of credibility um whenever we put our name and and mark alongside an agentic solution. So that very last ticket in there is you know how can we take all the work we've done and say hey when when it's an award we use these pieces if it's certification we use those pieces if it's you know the agent solution hub we we you know you know here's the criteria but I think it should all be it should all hang off of a single definition of what makes an agentic solution strong and good and trustworthy. we shouldn't make up four or five different definitions. And so that's what the last one is. And and hey, over time we're going to break these down into smaller pieces. I'm sure there's going to be other things we add to the list. I'm sure. Uh but this was the starting point that we came up with. Uh and uh we can again in probably in our next session we can figure out where we want to start uh and who wants uh to work on each different piece.

## 00:37:03

**Ronak Shah:** Yeah, makes sense. I still need to sort out my Slack access. Somehow I lost it. I have had it for years and something changed which ended up removing my Mac alliance.

**Rebecca Lyus:** uh so Mac alliance doesn't have an open slack now this is just private for the working groups uh we now have a community on gradual

**Ronak Shah:** Okay. Yeah, I'll reach out or I'll set up five minutes with you because there are

**Rebecca Lyus:** Yeah, I can sort that out for you.

**Ronak Shah:** some restriction within where I work with Amazon

**Rebecca Lyus:** Okay.

**Ronak Shah:** and uh trying to figure out how I get this sort out.

**Rebecca Lyus:** Yeah, no problem. We can get that sorted.

**Ronak Shah:** It's good. And yeah next time we meet I think I do talk with

**Rebecca Lyus:** Mhm.

**Ronak Shah:** many retailers and most of us do. So there are you know series of questions or series of concerns I hear and we can kind of see how we marry that. But it will be good to get something or hear something from Gus U like you're on other side.

## 00:38:24

**Ronak Shah:** So you know what would you be thinking of uh and that would help us shape this. Cool.

**Everett Zufelt:** And then uh Rebecca, is this a recurring invite in the calendar? I I didn't.

**Rebecca Lyus:** It is indeed.

**Everett Zufelt:** Awesome. Excellent.

**Rebecca Lyus:** So the next one will be is planned for the 1st of October.

**Everett Zufelt:** And I think some of us might I know I am in transit that day. Um, as some of the rest of us may be as well.

**Rebecca Lyus:** If we need to move it a day,

**Gus Fune:** Make sure Yes.

**Rebecca Lyus:** we can as well. So, it it might be easy if we do it on the Friday instead of the Thursday that week. We can be flexible if needs be.

**Ronak Shah:** Yeah.

**Rebecca Lyus:** Sorry.

**Ronak Shah:** Sorry wife.

**Rebecca Lyus:** All right. Uh if before the next session, I'll put a poll up in the Slack channel for which thing we want to start working on first of the issues and that way we can go into the call quite quickly.

## 00:39:38

**Gus Fune:** question. Do we want to work mostly on Slack or respond to the issues on GitHub? What is the best way for us to work synchronously on this before the meeting?

**Rebecca Lyus:** I feel like probably the best way because we can track it all in there as well. Um, what do you think, Everett?

**Everett Zufelt:** I'm I'm good with whatever works best for the group. Yeah.

**Rebecca Lyus:** We'll have a chat in Slack, then we'll either do Slack or GitHub. Um

**Gus Fune:** uh also I think we should pull up a few documents. I know I have a bunch of stuff.

**Rebecca Lyus:** Mhm.

**Gus Fune:** I take notes here the certification criteria but there was some there was some good

**Cecily Shives:** Mhm.

**Gus Fune:** output from the other work groups and also some other initiatives we had.

**Rebecca Lyus:** Yeah.

**Gus Fune:** I think there was one that was in February. There was some very good points that we could take in as well. For example, how this was discussed before in other places, but no action like let's work on something that will be a criteria or something.

## 00:40:46

**Rebecca Lyus:** Yeah.

**Gus Fune:** So, I'll try to see if I can pull up some stuff as well. I'm pushing the the GitHub repository.

**Rebecca Lyus:** Yeah, that sounds good. I didn't hear back from D. Oh. Uh, he had a fire emergency,

**Cecily Shives:** Oh god.

**Everett Zufelt:** Oh,

**Rebecca Lyus:** which is why he's not here. Uh, so that makes sense. Um, yeah. Okay, I'll speak to him.

**Gus Fune:** A literal fire because this time of the year is all fires.

**Cecily Shives:** Is it a fire drill or is it a He's had a fire.

**Rebecca Lyus:** He's just There was a fire emergency

**Everett Zufelt:** heat.

**Rebecca Lyus:** at 4:00 a.m. in the building.

**Cecily Shives:** Oh gosh,

**Gus Fune:** Oh,

**Cecily Shives:** that's like a real There are more important things than certific.

**Rebecca Lyus:** That's like a real that that's a real issue.

**Gus Fune:** literal fire.

**Rebecca Lyus:** Um, so fair enough.

**Cecily Shives:** That's scary.

**Rebecca Lyus:** Um, all right. Because all of our members have left, shall we close the call out and uh,

**Everett Zufelt:** Awesome.

**Rebecca Lyus:** async on Slack and get this party going? All right. Exciting.

**Everett Zufelt:** Thanks everyone.

**Rebecca Lyus:** Should we show you later?

**Cecily Shives:** Cool. Appreciate it, guys.

**Rebecca Lyus:** Hey

# Transcription ended after 00:42:04

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